

1

PROCEDURAL PYTHON EXAMPLES



Introductory courses and books typically teach software development using the procedural programming style, which involves splitting a program into a number of functions (also known as procedures or subroutines). You pass data into functions, each of which performs one or more computations and, typically, passes back results. This book is about a different paradigm of programming known as *object-oriented programming (OOP)* that allows programmers to think differently about how to build software. Object-oriented programming gives programmers a way to combine code and data together into cohesive units, thereby avoiding some complications inherent in procedural programming.

In this chapter, I'll review a number of concepts in basic Python by building two small programs that incorporate various Python constructs. The first will be a small card game called Higher or Lower; the second will be a simulation of a bank, performing operations on one, two, and multiple accounts. Both will be built using procedural programming—that is, using